User Management

UX Discovery Playback

March 2026

GWI.

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Goal of the discovery

To future proof design and development decisions grounded in real user needs.

Why this matters now

GWI's Goals

- Mass Adoption
- Operational Excellence
- Customer Obsession

As we scale

- More users per account
- Complex enterprise structures & security
- Higher expectations for self-serve

The work carried out

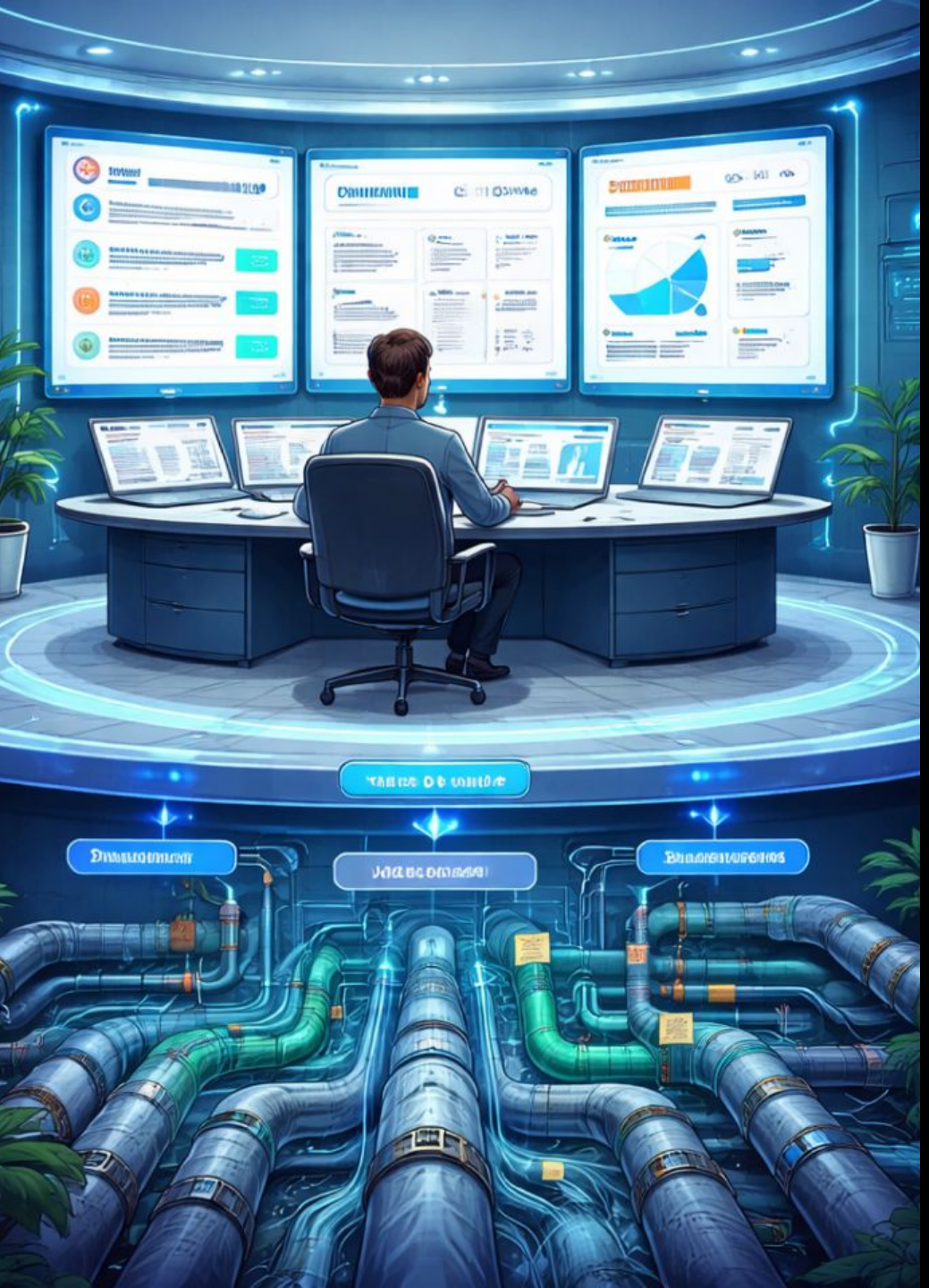
Workshops

- Proto-persona
- Key-player mapping
- Assumption mapping

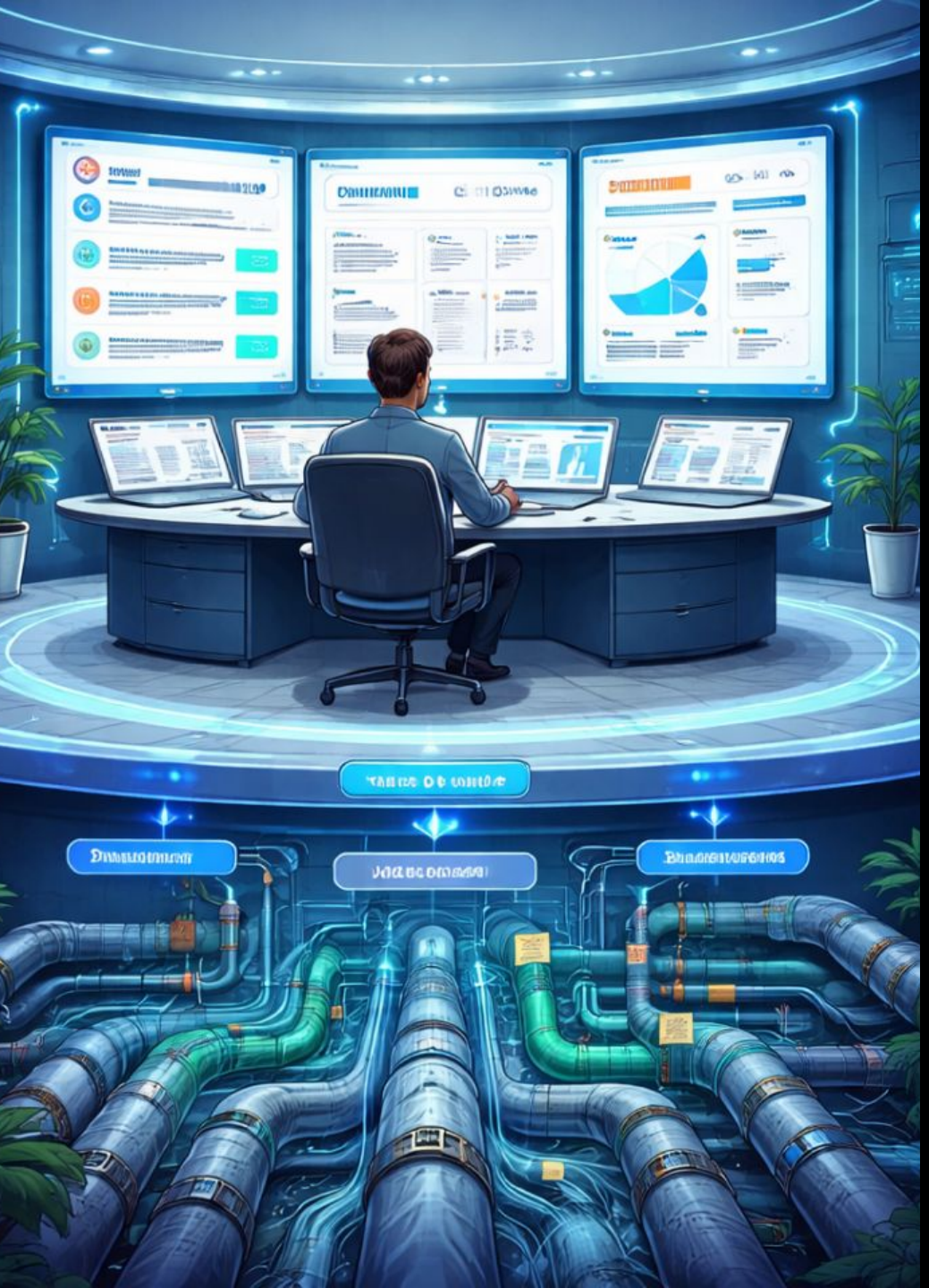
Exploratory interviews

- Customer Success
- Product Experience
- Account Director
- RevOps (Salesforce & Customer Operations)
- Product Managers
- Engineering

The story of UM today



Admin isn’t a tool — it’s our operating system



It controls:-

- Who can access the platform
- What they can see
- What they're paying for
- How value is tracked and proven

It underpins:-

- Customer experience (onboarding, access, trials, support)
- Product adoption (usage, engagement)
- Revenue (Contracts, seats, renewals)

Every critical part of our business depends on it **working correctly**

If UM works well

- Customers trust the platform
- Teams don’t rely on manual work
- Growth (SLG & PLG) becomes scalable

Today we're a long way from that...

On the surface, everything looks fine

- Users get access
- Contracts are fulfilled
- Reports are delivered

But underneath, the system works because people make it work

- Spreadsheets are the glue
- Teams reconcile data manually
- Workflows depend on memory
- No system-level safeguards

Research overview

A day in the life of managing Admin today

An Enterprise client story

Key research themes

Theme 1

We don’t have a system of truth — people are the system

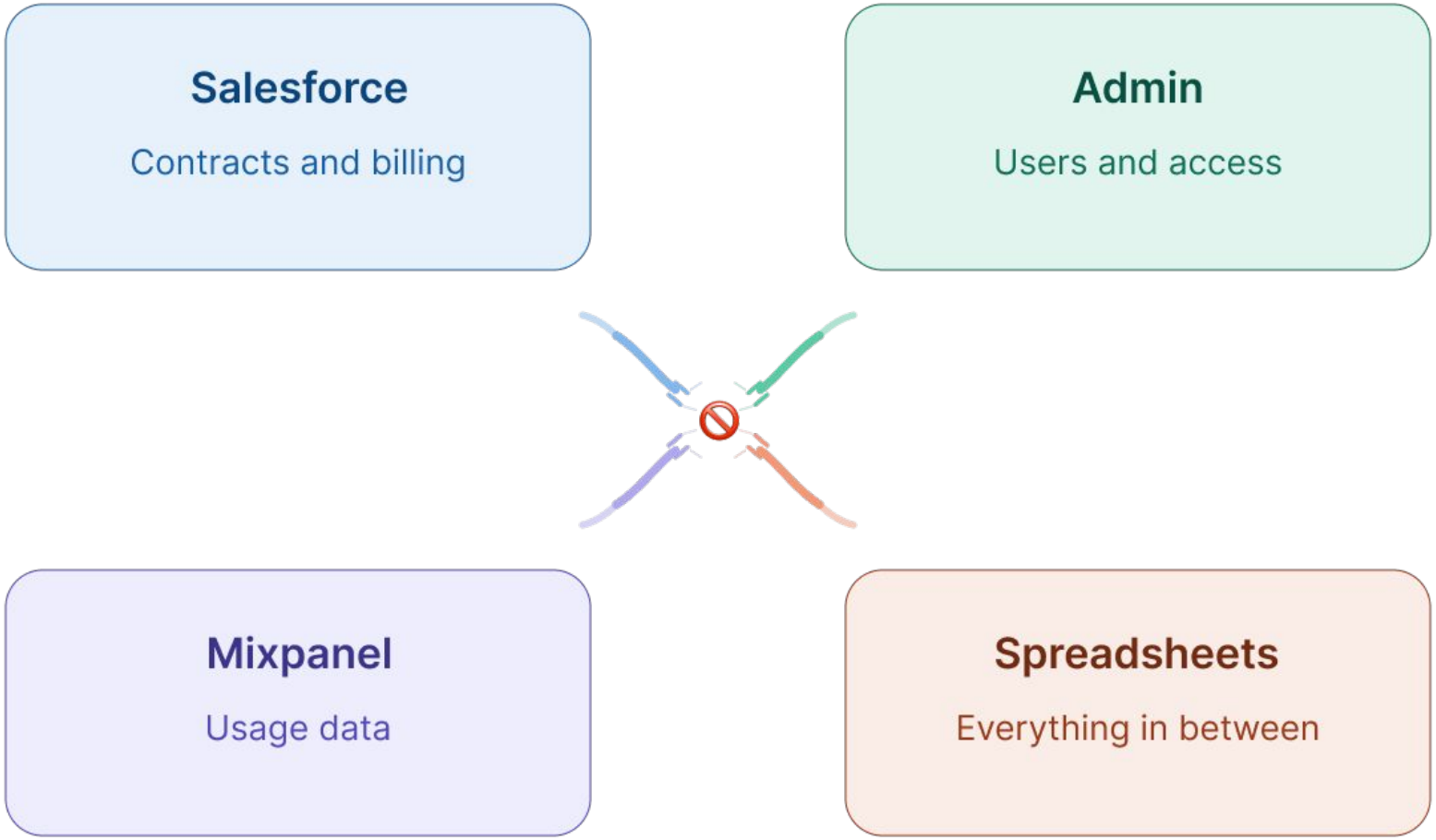
"Because as we all know, Admin does not speak to Salesforce, Mixpanel does not speak to Salesforce, etc."

RevOps

Key themes

We can’t trust our customer data

Systems are **disconnected** and often have no shared identifiers or modelling.



Internal user quotes

“Contracts don’t align with what’s in Admin.“

RevOps

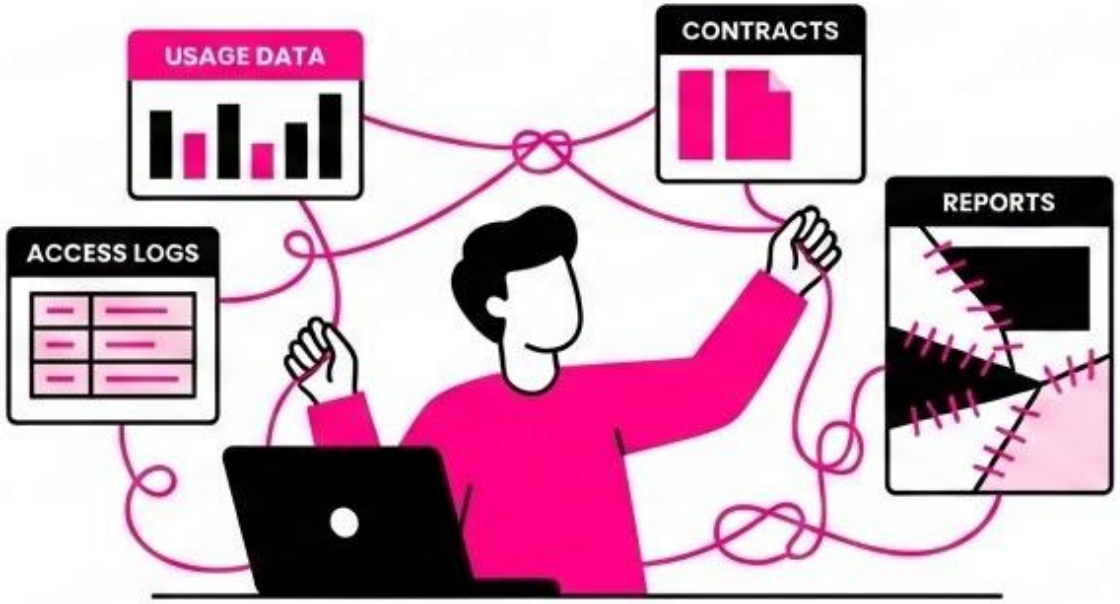
“No one trusts that there’s one single source of truth”

RevOps

Key themes

What this means

- Every workflow = manual reconciliation across multiple systems
- Contracts, usage, access = constantly cross-checked
- Reports = manually stitched together

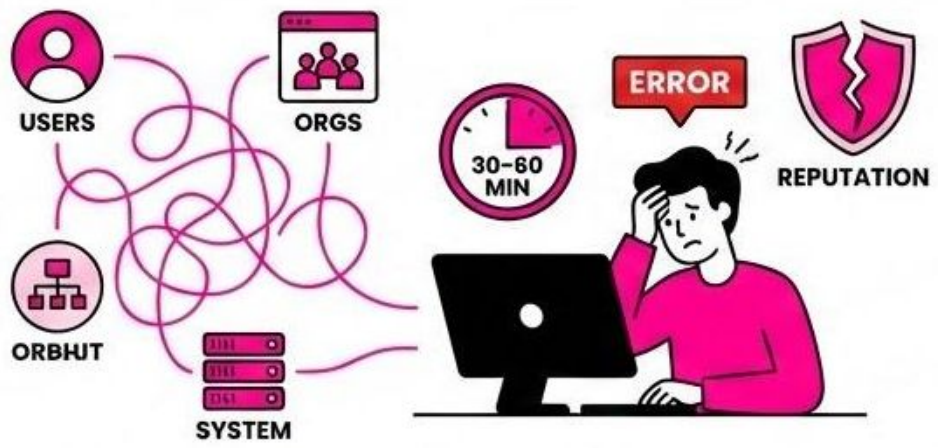


Key themes

Business impact

This creates real operational and revenue risk

- **No clear view** of customers or usage
- **Over/under provisioning** risk
- **30–60 minutes** per client report
- **High risk of human error**
- Inaccurate reporting = **trust risk**



Across teams, this creates hundreds of hours of manual work

Key themes

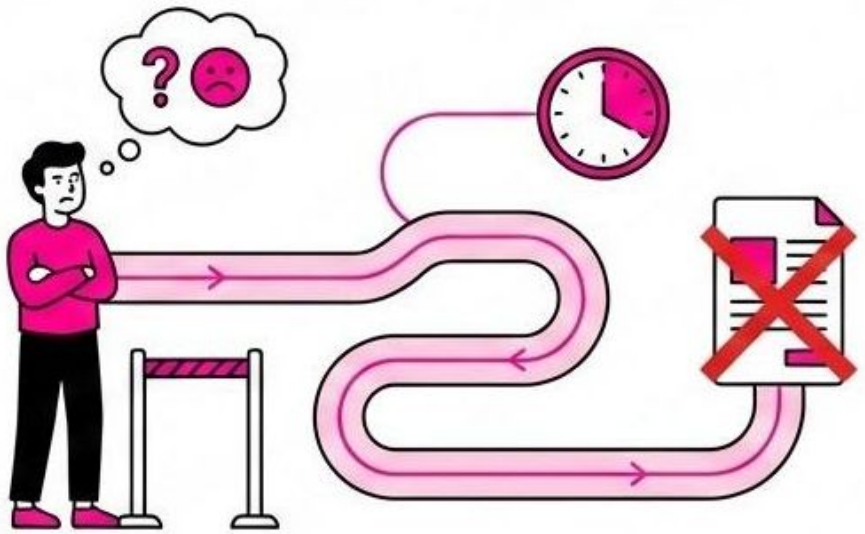
This directly impacts customer trust and value

Inaccurate reporting

Risk of delivering incorrect usage data, damaging trust and credibility

Slower time to value

Delays in onboarding and activation



“Publicis comms sent to 385 users compared to 477 expected”

RevOps

Theme 2

We don’t represent how customers actually operate

How many orgs with name Publicis exist on Admin platform today?

How many orgs with name Publicis exist on Admin platform today?

2,752... 😱

and counting!

Publicis

2752 results 0 selected)

	ID	Organisation name
☐	231	Ace Saatchi & Saatchi Philippines (Publicis Comms)
☐	158752	ALDI (Publicis Media)
☐	61858	Answered Insight (Publicis Media)
☐	72212	Apex Exchange (Publicis Media)
☐	156749	API_MarekNeufus_Publicis_SparkTrial_27/11/25
☐	132079	API_PublicisCoreUK_Trial_3/2/2025
☐	153927	API_PublicisGroupeNL_SparkTrial_6/10/2025

Enterprise examples

Our org model doesn’t reflect real enterprise structures

Publicis

- One contract
- 100s of agencies under umbrella
- Custom data-set access
- Separation needed due to conflict-of-interest

Samsung

- Regions on different contracts
- Different seat allocations
- Seats allocated per contract
- Potential future-sharing between orgs

Amazon

- Regional boundaries
- 100s of regional domains
- Functional teams spanning regions
- Custom dataset access
- Seats distributed globally

In reality, we use separate orgs to enforce boundaries: Contracts, Regions, Data access, Conflict-of-interest

But structurally we lack **connection** and **visibility.**

“We rely on naming conventions to know which orgs belong together.“

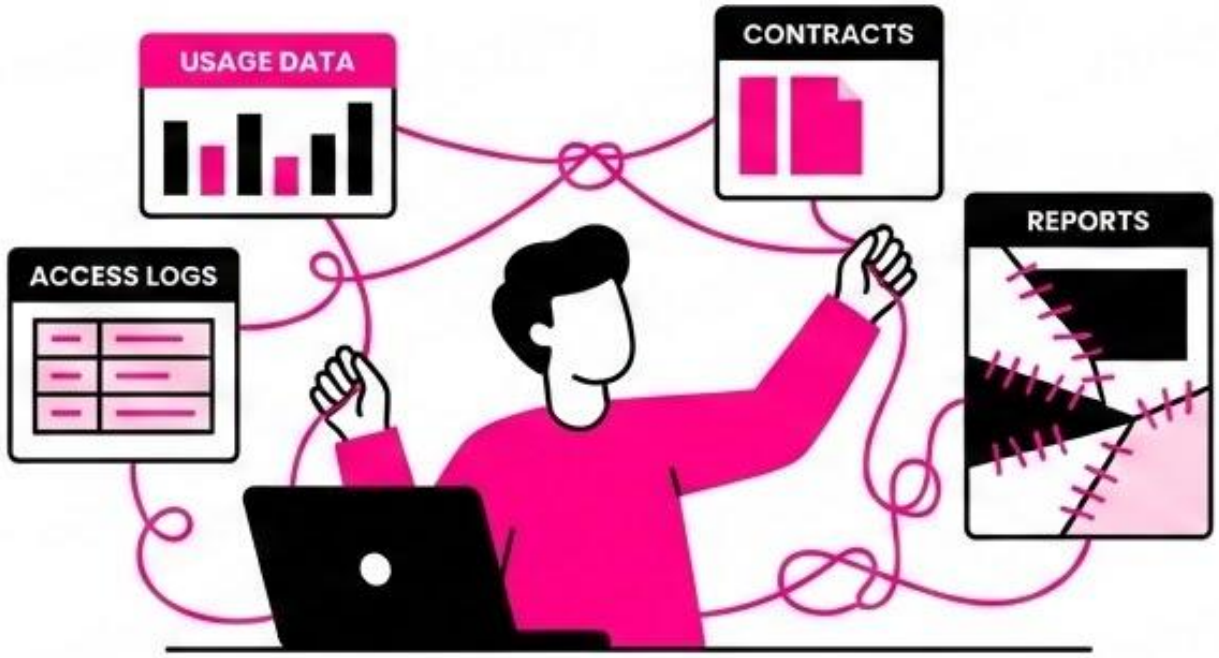
Customer Success

Key themes

What this means

~20% of admin issues are driven by org structure — but impact many more

- No roll-up view of an accounts
- No visibility of total seats or usage
- Risk of inaccurate reporting
- Org sprawl increases complexity



Theme 3

Access is unclear and ungoverned

“If we change the org bundles, we have to manually check who has user-level access.“

Product Experience

Key themes

Entitlements unclear and ungoverned

Visibility & logistic challenges

- User-level bundle overrides break org-level logic
- API tokens can only snapshot org bundles
- No visibility of who has what access (from feature flags to bundles)

Missing foundations & automation

- No concept of seats, roles or permissions defined
- No lifecycle management (trials, expiry, changes, API tokens)
- No guardrails

🚨 **Access is managed through memory and manual checks**

“It’s a memory game“

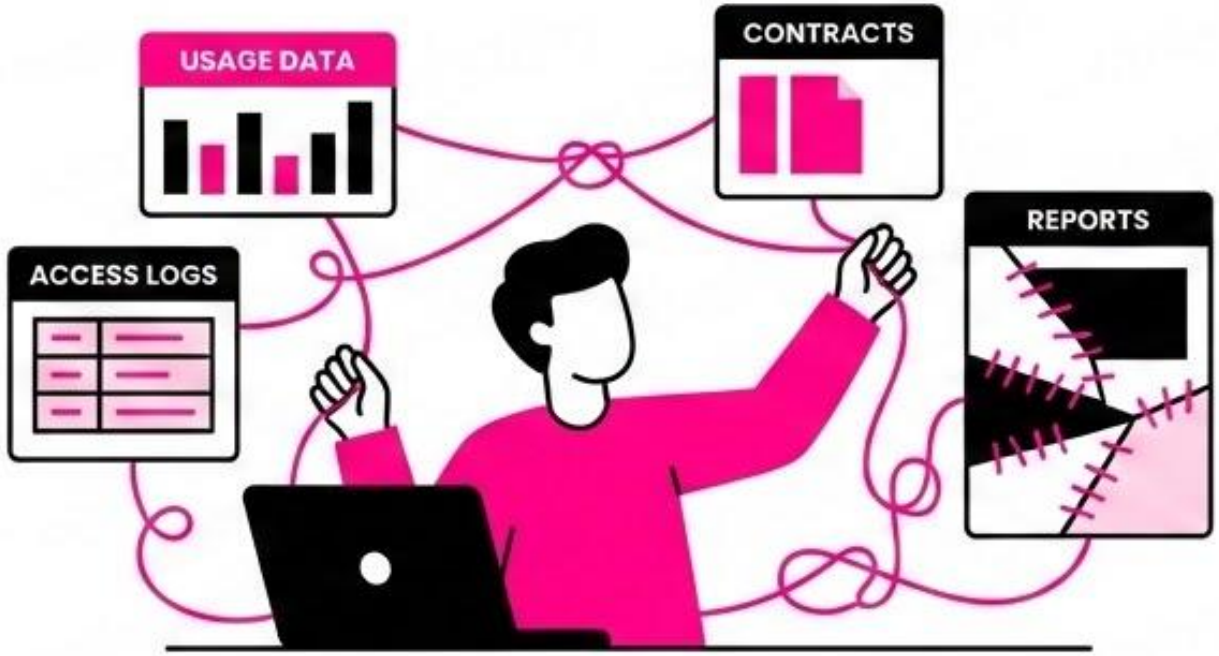
Product Experience

Key themes

What this means

~45% of admin tickets are driven by access issues

- Risk of over / under provisioning
- Inability to track contract alignment
- High volume of access-related tickets



Access cannot be controlled at scale

Theme 4

Support teams are manually acting as the system

“They (clients) have to go through us for everything ”

Enterprise CS

Key themes

Everything is manual

Every task requires human intervention

- **User setup**
- **Seat changes**
- **Bundle changes**
- **Permissions**
- **Reporting (API usage, user activity)**

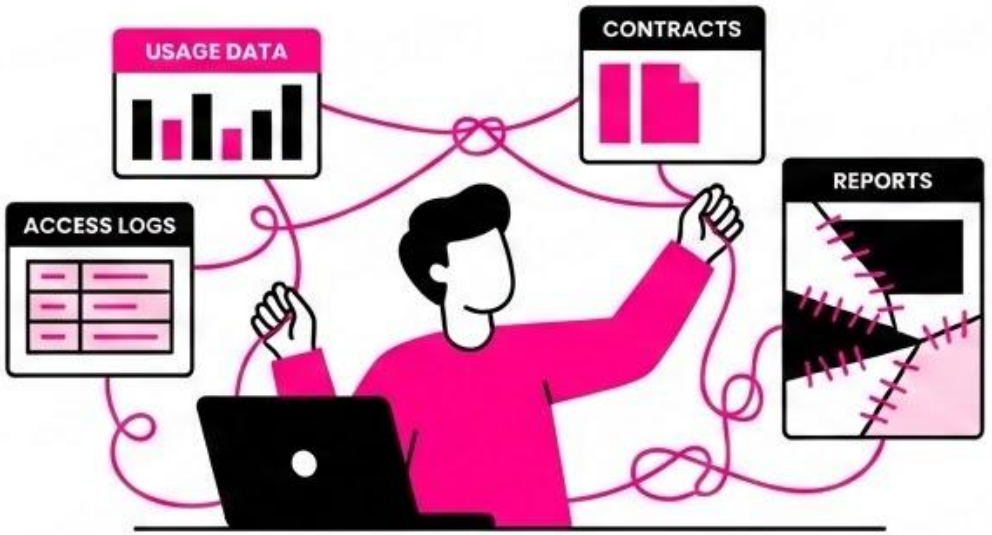
No automation, no guardrails, no system workflows

Key themes

What this means

~35% of admin tickets require manual intervention

- Support teams act as the system
- Daily repetitive tasks
- High risk of human error



PX and CS are the bottleneck for every change

Key themes

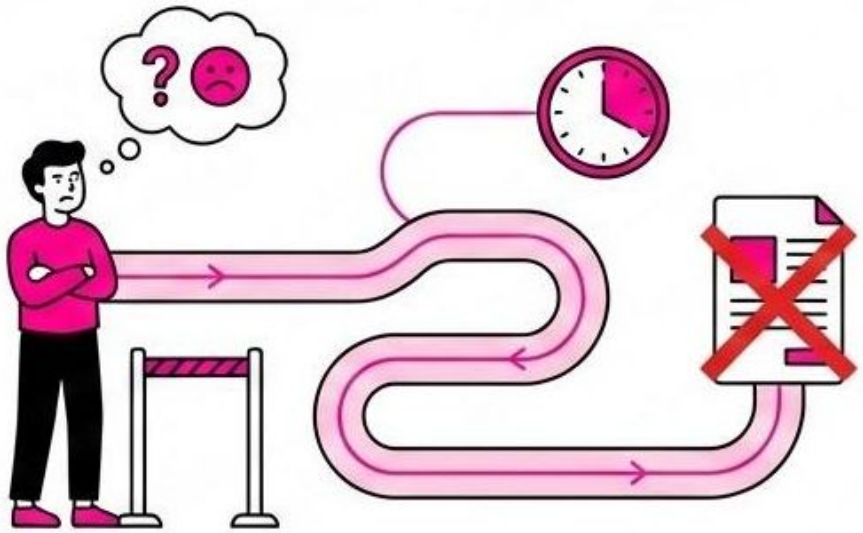
Customer impact

Vendor reliance

Delays for simple requests such as seat changes and usage

Enterprise expectations

Missed expectations of what business should deliver to enterprise clients



“There’s so much room for human error…Sending inaccurate reports undermines our credibility”

RevOps

The core problem

We are manually stitching together a system that was never designed to work together

We don’t have a system… we have workarounds

We don’t have a coherent model across

- Customers (orgs)
- Access (plans, features, bundles, datasets)
- Commercials (contracts, billing)

This breaks our ability to scale

We are trying to support two models — but our system supports neither

Sales-led (SLG)

- Complex contracts
- Custom access (datasets, users, orgs)
- Manual workflows

Flexible, but operationally heavy

Product -led (PLG)

- Standardised plans
- Self-serve
- Automated

Scalable but limited

What happens if we don’t fix this?

What's at stake

The risks of inaction

Operational impact

Manual workarounds and support bottlenecks

~500 hours spent on admin support (6 months)

~40–60% of this work is avoidable

Business scaling risk

Workload scales linearly with customer growth

Admin-related engineering work has grown 12.5x year on year

Revenue & data risk

No reliable view of customers or revenue

£36m misaligned or not visible across systems

Customer impact

Erodes customer trust and experience

100% of customer admin changes require vendor intervention

30-60 mins for every usage report

Looking to the future

What we need to enable as we scale

“As we mature as a business, clients will expect to manage this themselves”

Product Experience

Self-serve

Customer expectations have already changed

Customers expect to:-

- Manage users and seats
- Control access and permissions
- Track usage and value
- Make changes instantly

👉 **Without relying on support teams**

Self-serve

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- Track usage and value
- Make changes instantly

👉 **Without relying on support teams**

The challenge with today's system

- There is no single source of truth
- Organisations are fragmented and disconnected
- Access rules are inconsistent + ungoverned
- Workflows are manual and lack automation

What needs to change

To enable this we need to fix the foundation — not layer on more workflows

The path forward

01 Fix the model

Represent customers properly across organisations

02 Standardise access

Create a clear, consistent model for permissions and entitlements

03 Automate workflows

Remove human dependency

👉 **Move from a human-operated system → to a scalable platform**

“I would love for us to be able to align the two systems”

Rev Ops (Salesforce)

What this enables as we scale

Reduce operational overhead

Move away from manual reporting, setup and access management

→ ***Free up hundreds of hours across CS, PX and RevOps***

Scale enterprise clients effectively

Support complex org structures, contracts and access models

→ ***Without increasing cost to serve***

Create a trusted, unified system

Align contracts, users and usage in one model

→ ***Accurate reporting, better decisions, stronger renewals***

The future

How does Work OS fit in

The future

How does WorkOS fit in?

What work OS enables

- Authentication (SSO, Login, security)
- User identity & lifecycle (provisioning)
- Token generation & management
- Standard user data (Email, identity)

The future

How does WorkOS fit in?

What work OS enables

- ✅ Authentication (SSO, Login, security)
- ✅ User identity & lifecycle (provisioning)
- ✅ Token generation & management
- ✅ Standard user data (Email, identity)

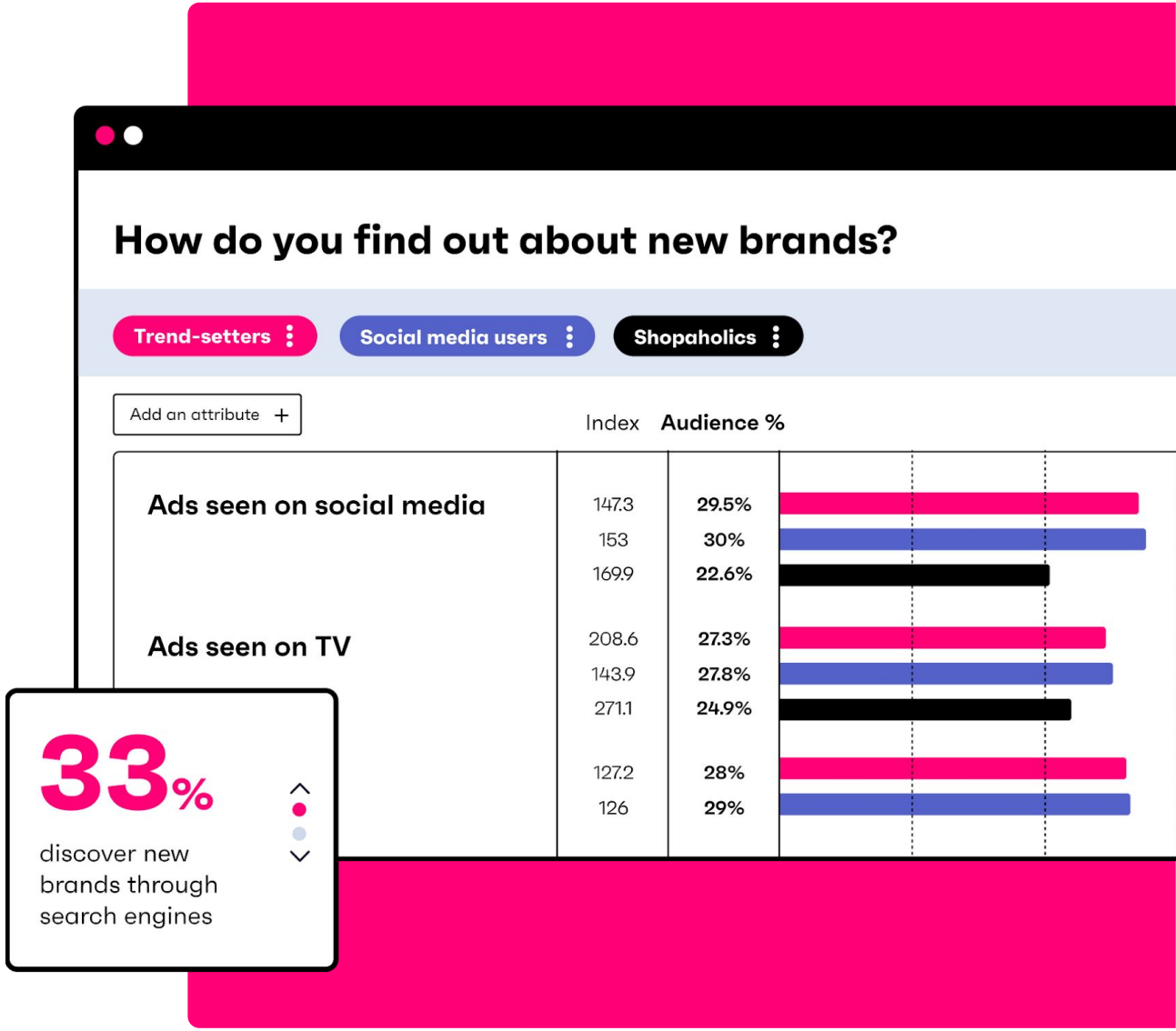
What work OS does not solve

- ❌ Organisation structure
- ❌ Entitlements (plans, features, datasets)
- ❌ Roles & permissions
- ❌ Billing & subscriptions
- ❌ Reporting and usage visibility

👆 **These remain our responsibility**

WorkOS

WorkOS is an enabler for identity and authentication. We still need to define the model to sits underneath it.



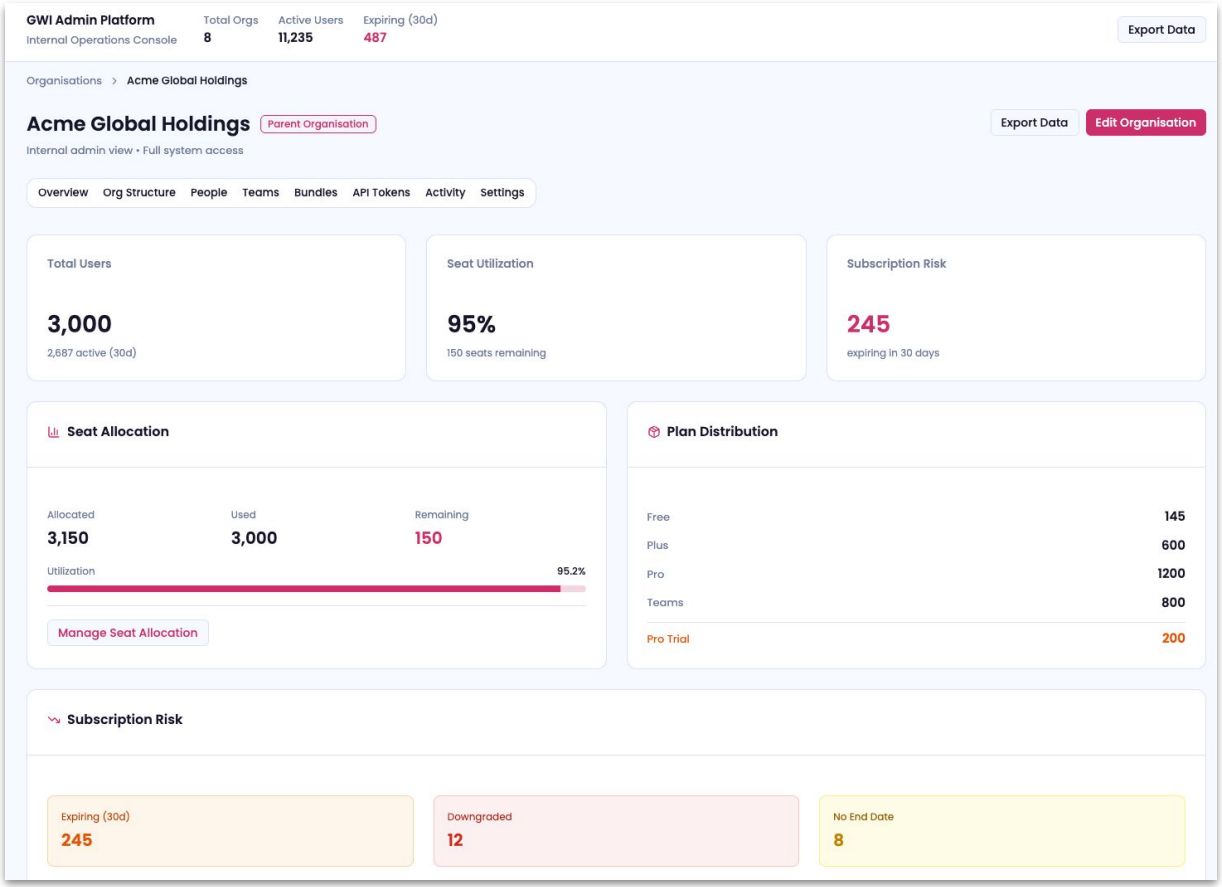
The future

What good could look like

The future

Future admin platform

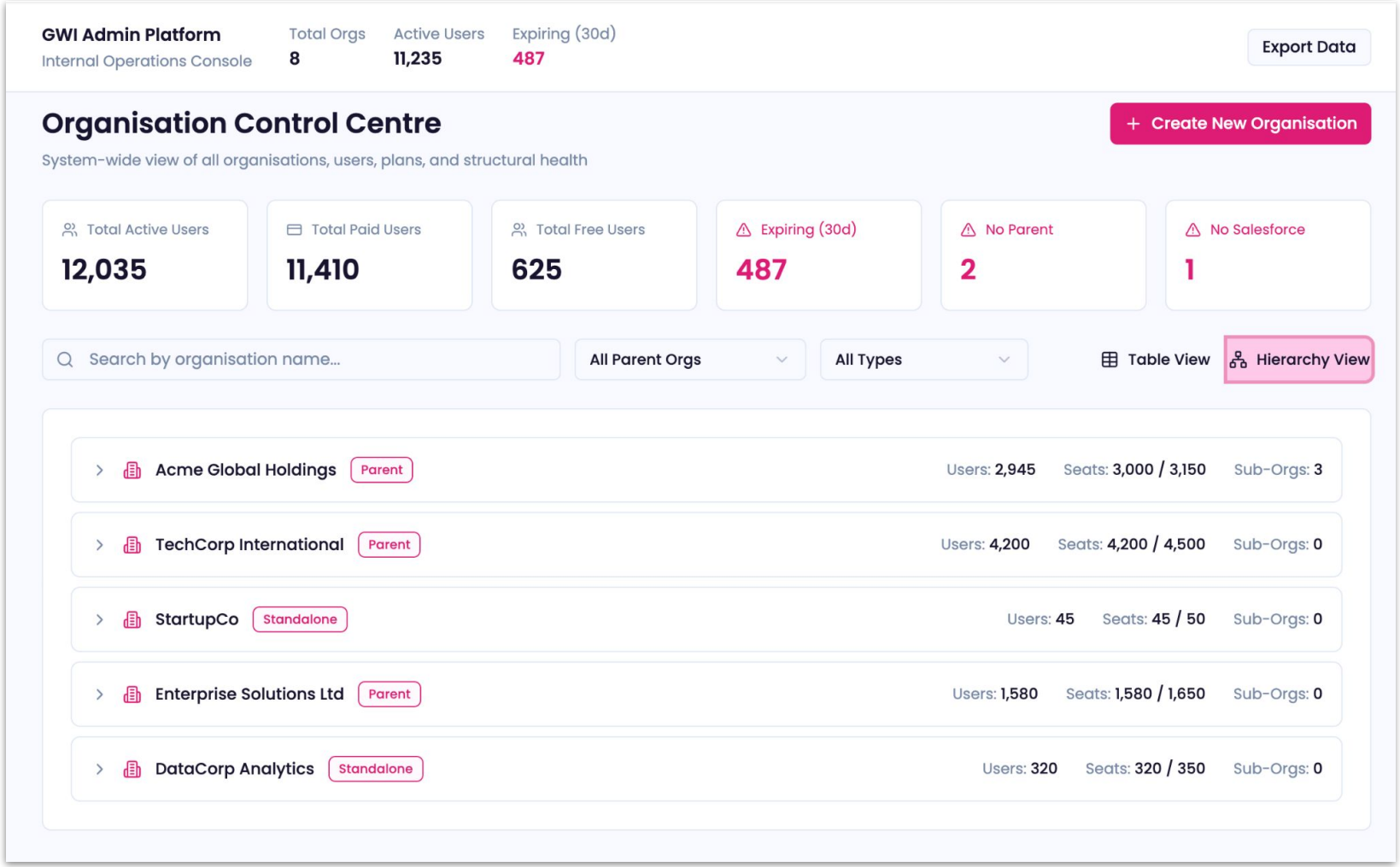
- Clear visibility into access and usage
- Clear roll up view of accounts
- Systems aligned behind a single model
- Lifecycle automation



Teams focused on growth, not manual set-up

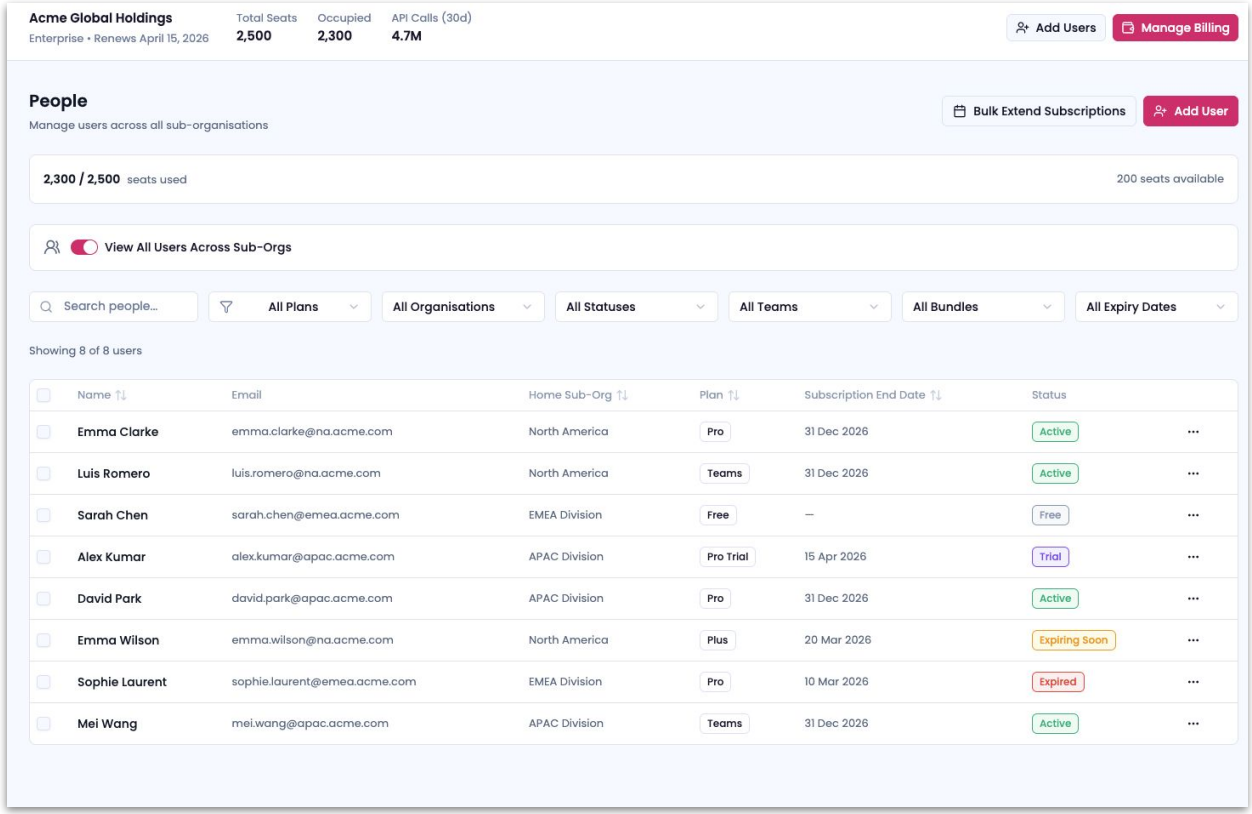
The future

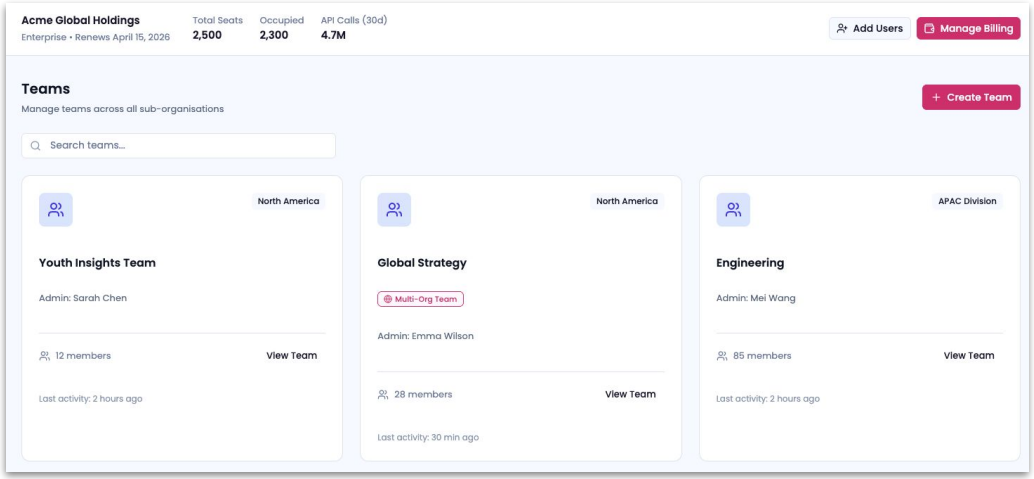
Future admin platform



The future

Future admin platform





The future

Self-serve MVP

What capabilities to enable for MVP

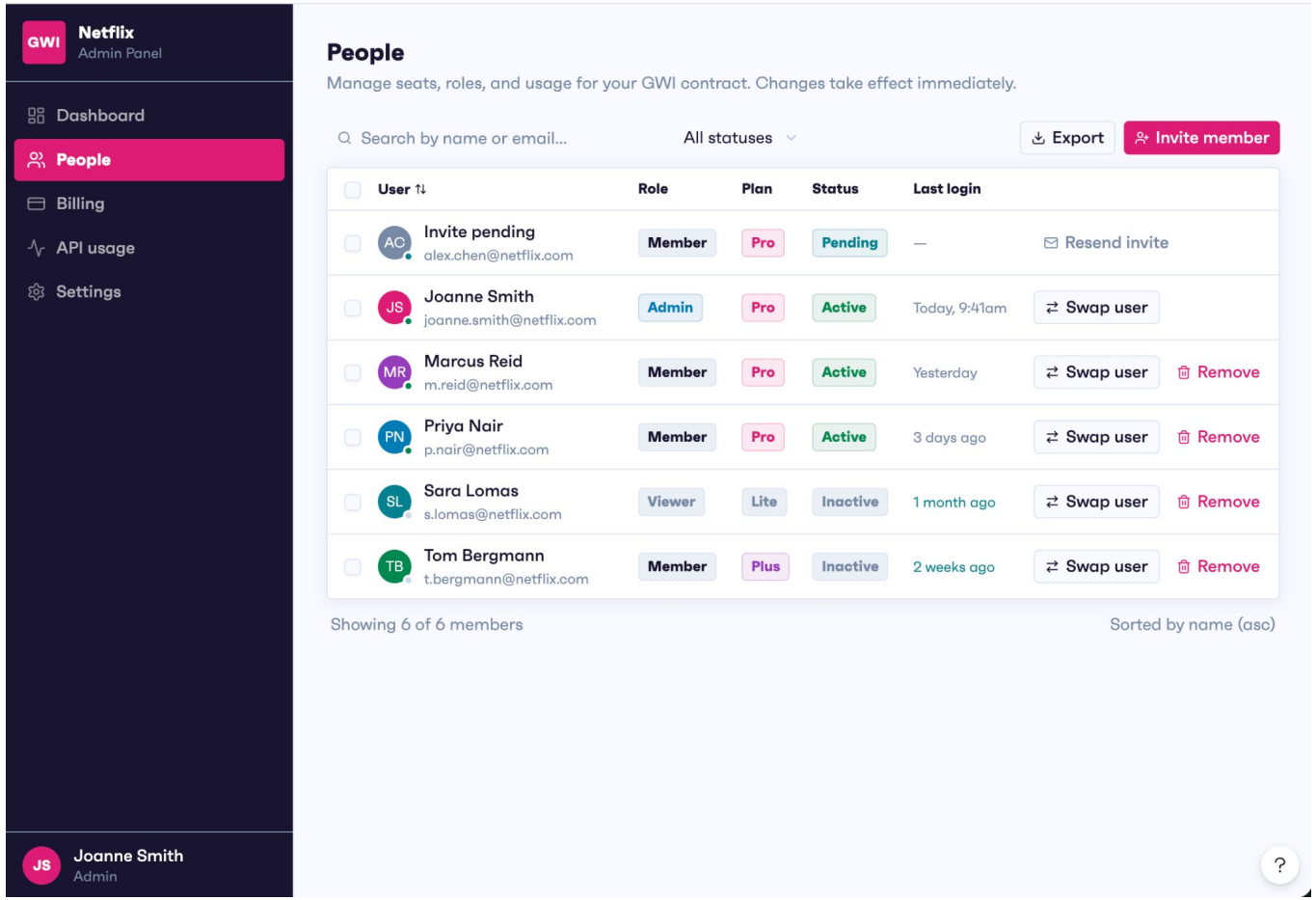
- User management (add, remove, swap users
- Basic user visibility (last login, active, inactive
- Admin role management
- Subscription overview
- Plan and bundle access visibility
- API access and usage

What we would need to have in place

- Seat cap enforcement
- User lifecycle states
- Role-based permission model
- Usage tracking and measurements (active, inactive, login)
- Access visibility per user + org
- API usage data

The future

Self-serve MVP



Link to prototype

Next steps

What we propose next

What

Cross-functional OOUX workshops to agree on proposed future system modelling

UM DISCOVERY

Proposed Future Object Model

Click on any card to view detailed information and relationships.

Org (Parent) — Structural

A structural boundary that groups users, teams, and access configuration within an account. Defines the entitlement boundary for all contained users.

Org (Child) — NEW, Structural

A structural boundary that groups users, teams, and access configuration within an account. Inherits entitlement boundaries from parent org.

Account — Commercial

A commercial grouping object that links multiple organisations under a single customer record for reporting and account management purposes.

Org Team — NEW, Structural

An operational grouping of users within an org used for collaboration and scoped bundle access.

User — Identity

An individual identity within an organization that consumes a seat and inherits access.

Plan — Access

A commercial plan that controls which features are available to end users. Plans define the capability tier assigned to users within an organisation.

Feature — Access

An atomic system capability that can be enabled or disabled for a user. Features may be customer-facing, internal-only, API-level, or experimental.

Bundle — Access

A collection of data access configurations assigned at org, team, or user level.

Role — NEW, Access

A permission template controlling administrative capabilities within an organization.

AccessGrant — Access

A time-bound access record that defines when a user can access the system within an organisation. Access dates default from the Org's entitlement window but may be overridden per user within organisational limits.

Seat Allocation — NEW, Access

Defines total seats available to an organization and tracks consumption.

API Token — Access

A programmatic credential scoped to an organization and its bundle access.

Domain — TBC, Identity

A verified email domain used for SSO and identity binding.

DomainAssociation — TBC, Identity

A linking object connecting verified domains to organizations.

Want to know more?

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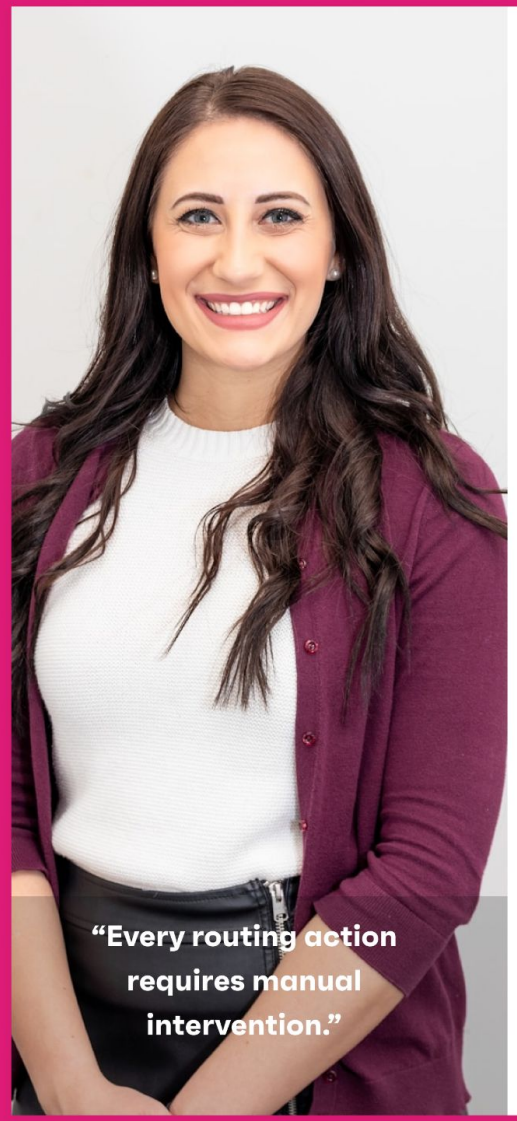
Appendix

Personas

Link to UM personas



USER PERSONA

Product Experience

Supports CS, Sales & Clients via user, access, org and token management

BIO

Product Experience work at the centre of operations. They are the **execution layer** between Salesforce, Intercom, Admin and the customer.
The set up **orgs**, **manage users** and **bundles**, generate **API tokens**, and resolve **access issues** across a stream of requests from CS, Sales and clients via Intercom, Assana and Salesforce.

ADMIN TOUCHPOINTS

User Set up | Bundle assignment | User changes | Masquerading | Device resets | API token generation

JOBS TO BE DONE

- Ensure users get the right access, at the right time, with minimal friction.
- Set up and maintain orgs, users, bundles and API tokens accurately
- Troubleshoot issues quickly to unblock clients and internal teams.
- Bridge gaps between Salesforce (contracts) and Admin (reality)
- Support in onboarding, trials, reporting and account changes

NEEDS

- Single source of truth across Salesforce, Assana, Admin and usage data
- Clear visibility and validation of access (org, users, bundles)
- Bulk operations (user set up, bundles, org management)
- Guardrails to prevent errors before they happen
- Visibility of overrides and exceptions (e.g. user-level bundles)
- Automation of repetitive tasks
- Movement toward self-serve to reduce PX dependency

FRUSTRATIONS

Everything is manual
User setup, bundle changes, org creation (done one-by-one)

Disconnected systems
Salesforce, Admin, Mixpanel, Intercom don't align

Single point of failure
Every access request routes through PX -> bottlenecks

Repetitive tickets
Device resets, access issues, trials - the same fixes daily

No visibility
User-level bundle overrides are invisible and persist silently

Fragile API tokens
Static, require manual regeneration, no expiry

No guardrails
Errors surface only after users complain

Manual workarounds
Spreadsheets for access, usage and report tracking

Additional links

User Research calls

Confluence page

OOUX Future Modelling (WIP)

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